



country was divided in the aftermath of World War II—the western part became the Federal Republic while the eastern zone, dominated by the communist Soviet Union, became the German Democratic

Republic. The GDR was the poor relation, so much so that a wall was erected to prevent East Germans from defecting to the West. The Berlin Wall came down in 1989 amid great rejoicing and emotional reunions.

THE BRANDENBURG GATE

Berlin's Brandenburg Gate is an important landmark. It was modeled on the entrance to Athen's Acropolis and was completed in 1791. Ironically, though intended to symbolize peace, the gate was incorporated into the Berlin Wall and its meaning only restored in 1989 when the wall came down.

The Gate is a major tourist attraction. Only taxis, buses, and officials are allowed to drive through it now.



GERMAN SAUSAGES

There are thousands of different types of *wurst* (German sausages); some are cooked and eaten hot while others are sliced or spread. The meat—mostly pork, sometimes beef or veal—is combined with peppercorns, spices, and other ingredients.



WOOD CARVING WORKSHOP

A clockmaker carves the face for a cuckoo clock in his Black Forest workshop. Cuckoo clocks were first made in the 18th century when peddling “clock carriers” found customers for them by literally carrying the clocks around in backpacks to prospective buyers. Demand still remains high for the handmade clocks today.



CAR INDUSTRY

Germany was producing 900 cars a year in 1901. Today, the number is closer to 10 million, and firms such as Audi, Daimler, Mercedes, BMW, Volkswagen, and Porsche employ 1.26 million people.

